

HTTP Request Methods

HEAD Method

The **HEAD** method is similar to **GET**, but it **returns only the response headers** and **does not return the response body**.

Uses

- Check if a resource exists.
- Get the file size before downloading.
- Check the content type.
- Check the last modification date.

Example

Request

```
HEAD /api/products/1 HTTP/1.1
```

Response

```
HTTP/1.1 200 OK
Content-Type: application/json
Content-Length: 350
Last-Modified: Mon, 06 Jul 2026 10:30:00 GMT
```

The response contains **headers only** and no body.

CONNECT Method

The **CONNECT** method is used to **establish a tunnel** between the client and the server, usually through a **proxy server**.

It is mainly used to create secure **HTTPS (TLS/SSL)** connections.

Uses

- Establish a secure HTTPS connection.
- Create a tunnel through a proxy server.
- Enable encrypted communication between the client and the server.

Example

Request

```
CONNECT www.example.com:443 HTTP/1.1  
Host: www.example.com:443
```

Response

```
HTTP/1.1 200 Connection Established
```

After the connection is established, encrypted data is exchanged through the tunnel.

Summary of HTTP Request Methods

Method	Description
GET	Retrieve data from the server.
POST	Create a new resource.
PUT	Update an entire resource.
PATCH	Update part of a resource.
DELETE	Delete a resource.
HEAD	Retrieve only the response headers.
CONNECT	Establish a secure tunnel through a proxy server.
OPTIONS	Show the HTTP methods supported by the server.
TRACE	Echo the received request for debugging purposes.